

appear here with a runway of around 12 months.

The next cluster comprises start-ups with 15-36 months of runway. This group includes Ola Electric Mobility, Pepperfry, Spinny, and BharatPe. Ola Electric Mobility has an 18-month runway based on FY25 data, as it reported a net cash outflow of ₹ 200 crore per month while its cash reserves stood at ₹3,518 crore as of March 2025, as per CMIE data.

Ola Electric is now a publicly listed company. This gives the company better access to public market capital. However, given the company's scale of operation and the competition in the sector, a runway of 18 months is generally considered risky and borderline.

Swiggy, the food delivery app, has a net cash out-

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flow of ₹2,170 crore from operating activities, while the company reported ₹4,623 crore in cash and liquid investments as of March 2025, giving it a runway of about 26 months at the current cash burn rate.

Rapido, the bike-taxi company, recorded a cash burn of ₹255 crore in FY25. But with ₹731 crore in cash, they have around three years of runway without needing more funding, even if they keep burning cash at the same rate.

At the upper end, start-ups such as Unacademy, Rebel Foods, PharmEasy, Cars24, and Amagi have over three years of runway, giving them strategic flexibility.

Some companies stand out for exceptionally long runways. First Cry, for instance, has over 20 years of runway at its current burn rate. Amagi, a Bengaluru-

based SaaS start-up, has enough money to last over four years. Edtech major Unacademy had ₹1,168 crore in cash as of March 2025, as per CMIE data, which translates into a 37-month runway, at the current burn rate.

Blinkit has almost ten years of runway left. It spent ₹165 crore more than it earned but had ₹1,036 crore in cash and an additional ₹576 crore in current investments as of March 2025. Zomato acquired Blinkit in 2022. With Zomato's support, and as its losses narrow, Blinkit should be able to become profitable soon, as Zomato did.

BURN QUALITY

Not all cash burns are the same. Some start-ups burn cash in capital expenditure to fuel growth and build future value, while others do it to keep the business running. Two start-ups can have the same runway, but very different outcomes, depending on whether their burn is driving growth or covering inefficiencies.

Take Spinny. The used-car marketplace acquired vehicle servicing start-up GoMechanic in November last year for ₹450 crore, according to Tracxn data.

In FY25, Spinny reported operating revenue of ₹4,746 crore, as per CMIE data, up 25% from the previous fiscal. Its net loss also narrowed, showing improved operating performance and better unit economics.

Based on FY25 numbers, Spinny has an estimated runway of about 30 months. While the company continues to improve its unit economics, a portion of its existing cash burn is tied to acquisitions that could later translate into higher revenues.

A similar strategy can be seen at VerSe Innovation Pvt. Ltd., the Bengaluru-based unicorn that runs Dailyhunt, a news aggregator, and Josh, a short-video platform.

The company made two acquisitions last fiscal year, Valueleaf and Magzter. Valueleaf is a digital marketing firm that is being integrated with VerSe's NexVerse. ai ad-tech platform, while Magzter is a global digital newsstand, which was acquired to start a subscription model and reduce dependence on advertising revenue.

In contrast, Mohalla Tech Private Ltd—the Bengaluru-based parent company of social media platform ShareChat and short-video app Moj—is burning cash largely due to financial obligations rather than growth investments. Mohalla reported an annual cash burn of ₹432 crore in FY25, with a total income of ₹757 crore, against expenses of ₹1,865 crore. About 36% of its total expenses went towards debt servicing, including interest payments. As of March 2025, the company's books carry long-term debt in the form of debentures and bonds worth ₹5,061 crore. This gives Mohalla Tech a runway of just about four months, with a large part of the burn tied to debt servicing and not capex.